Install Git

Digital Technologies · Personal computers

You will

- download and install Git
- set VS Code as Git's editor and main as the first branch
- check Git works

You need

- a Windows computer you're allowed to install apps on (Chromebooks can't run Git)
- VS Code installed first (see the guide Install VS Code)

Before you start

- Git keeps the history of your project. GitHub Desktop and VS Code both use it.
- Most screens are left as they are. This guide shows the two you change.

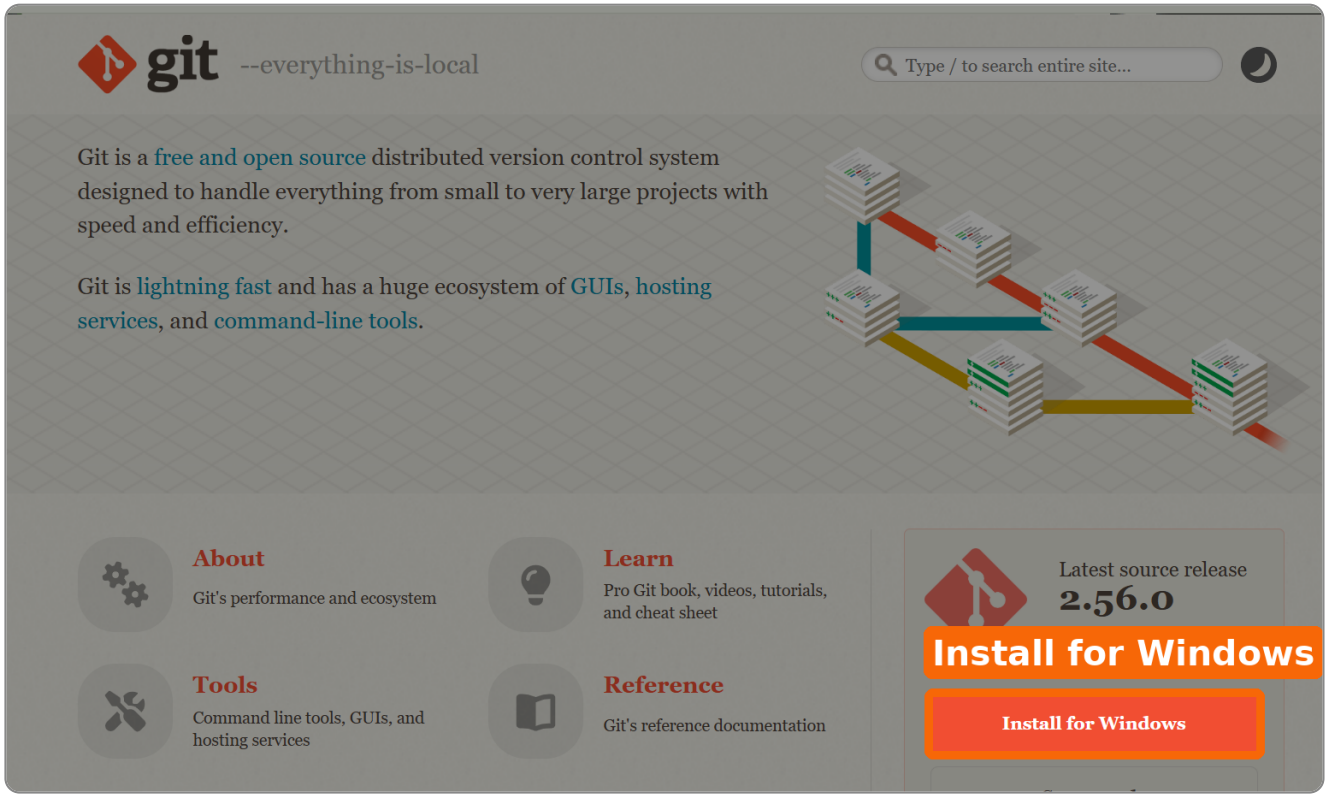
 Click here  Look here

1

Chrome › git-scm.com

Go to `git-scm.com`.

Click **Install for Windows**.

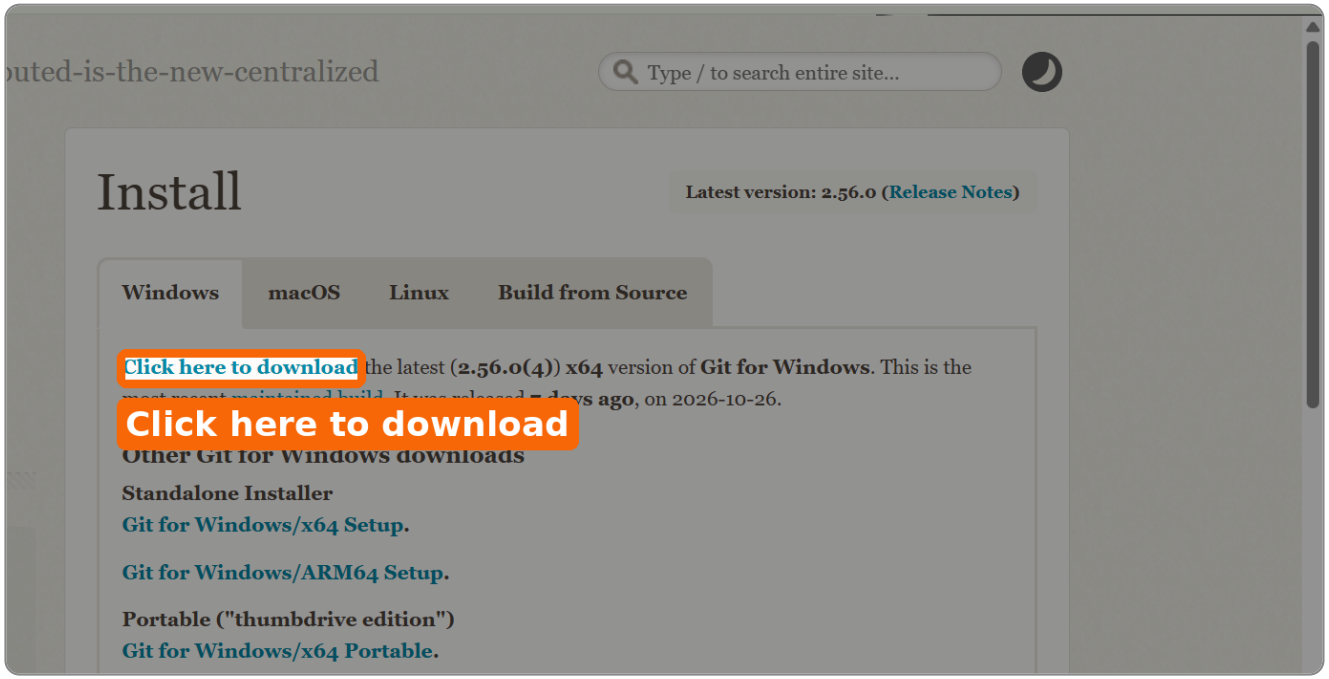


2

Chrome › Install for Windows

Click **Click here to download**.

This downloads the newest Git for most Windows computers.



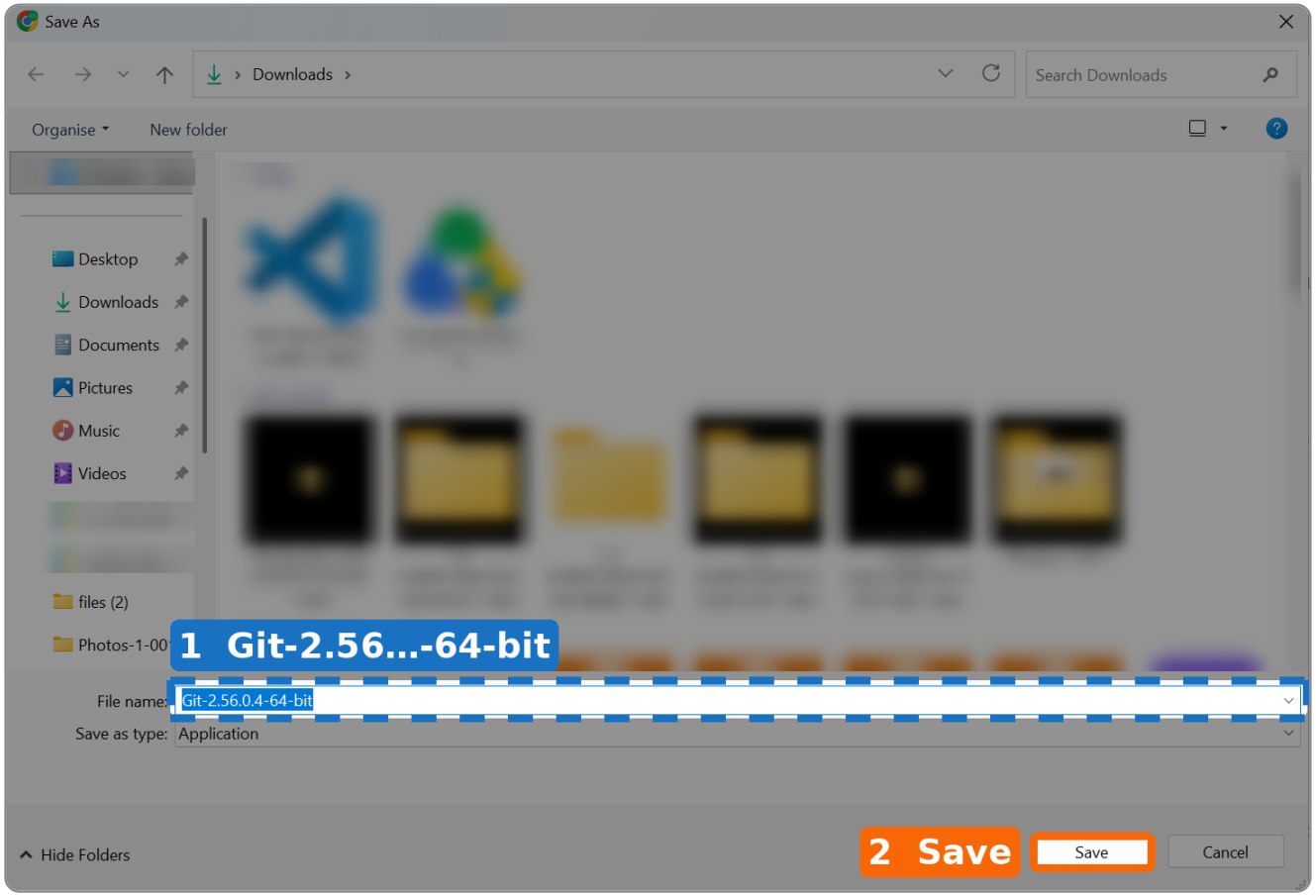
3

Chrome › Save As › only if it opens

Leave the name as it is.

Click **Save**.

Most computers skip this window and download straight away.



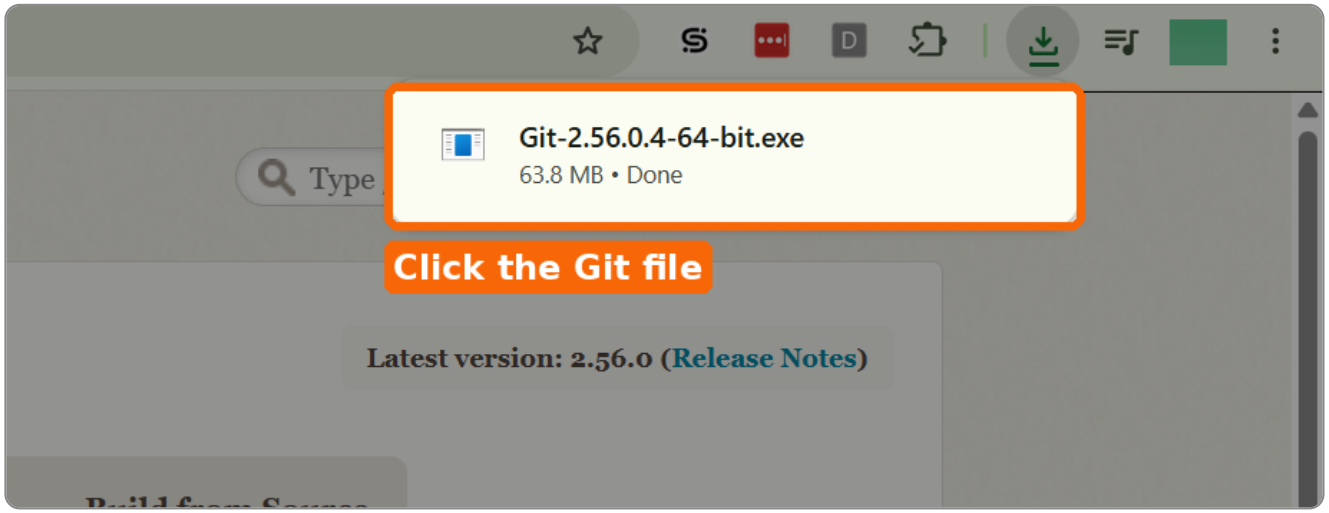
4

Chrome › Downloads

When it says Done, click the Git file.

If Windows asks whether to allow the app to make changes, click **Yes**.

Can't see it? Press Ctrl + J to open your downloads.



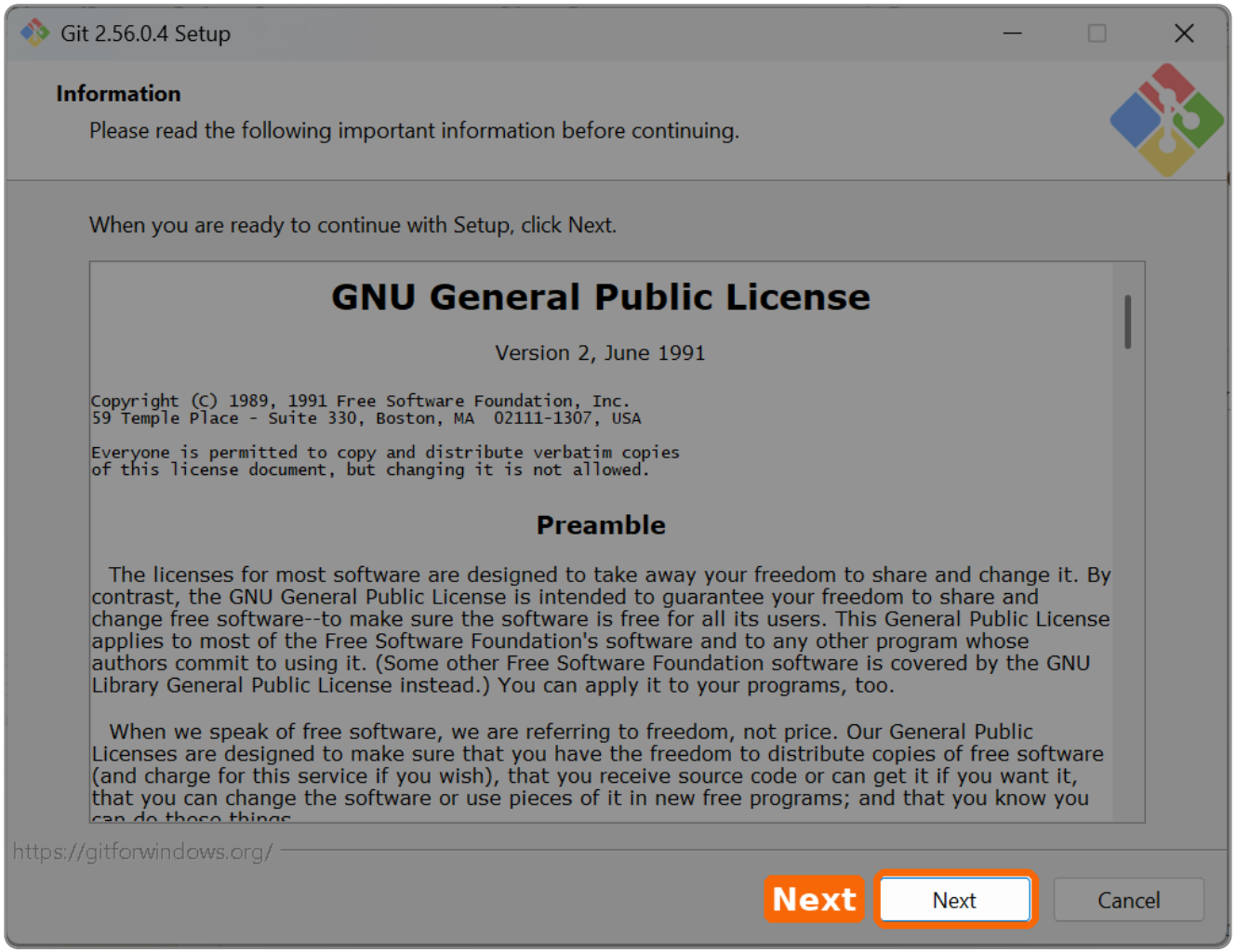
5

Git Setup › Information

Click **Next**.

On the next three screens, leave everything as it is and click **Next**.

Those are Select Destination Location, Select Components and Select Start Menu Folder.



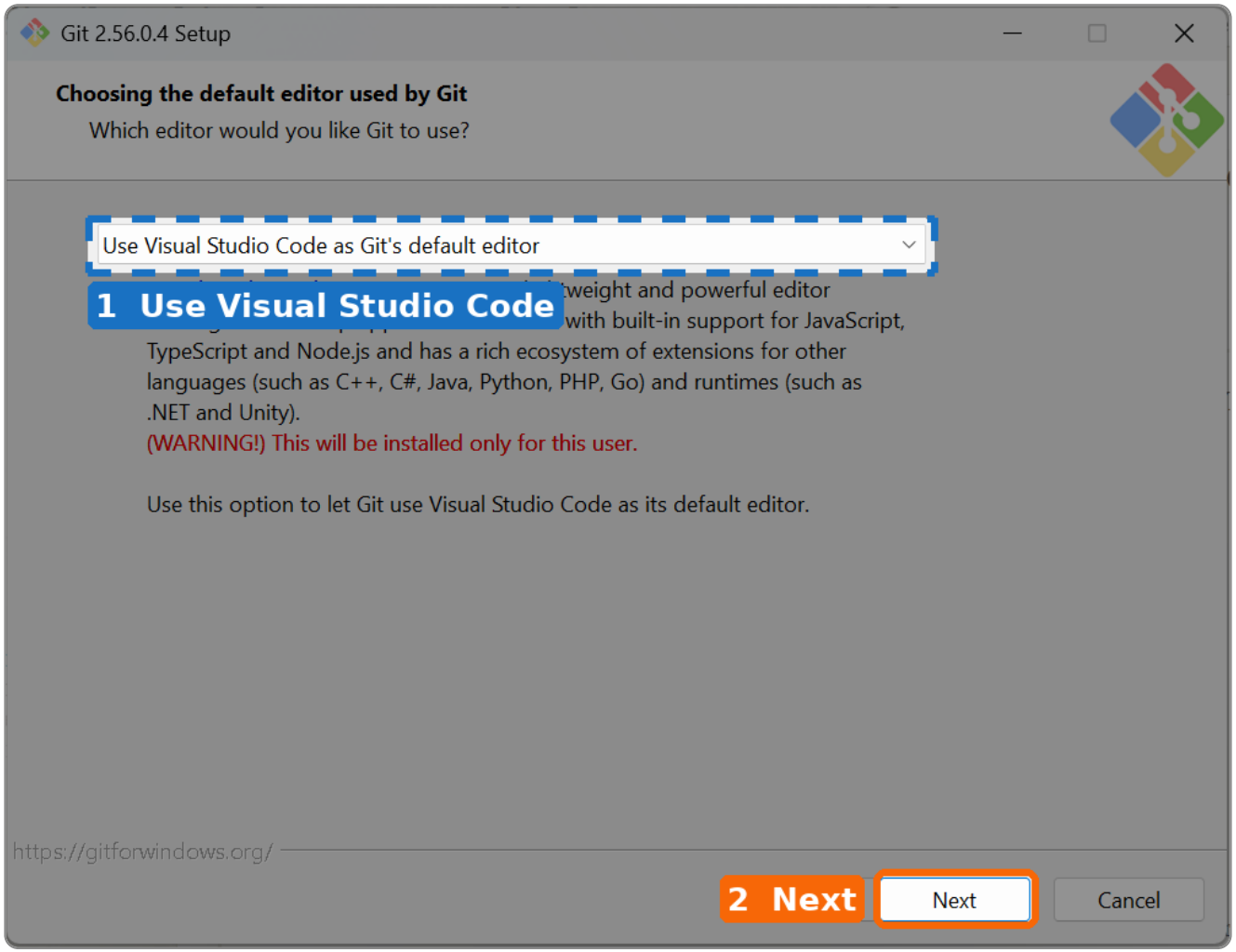
6

Git Setup › Choosing the default editor

Click the box and choose **Use Visual Studio Code as Git's default editor**.

Click **Next**.

VS Code isn't in the list? Install it first (see the guide Install VS Code), then start again.



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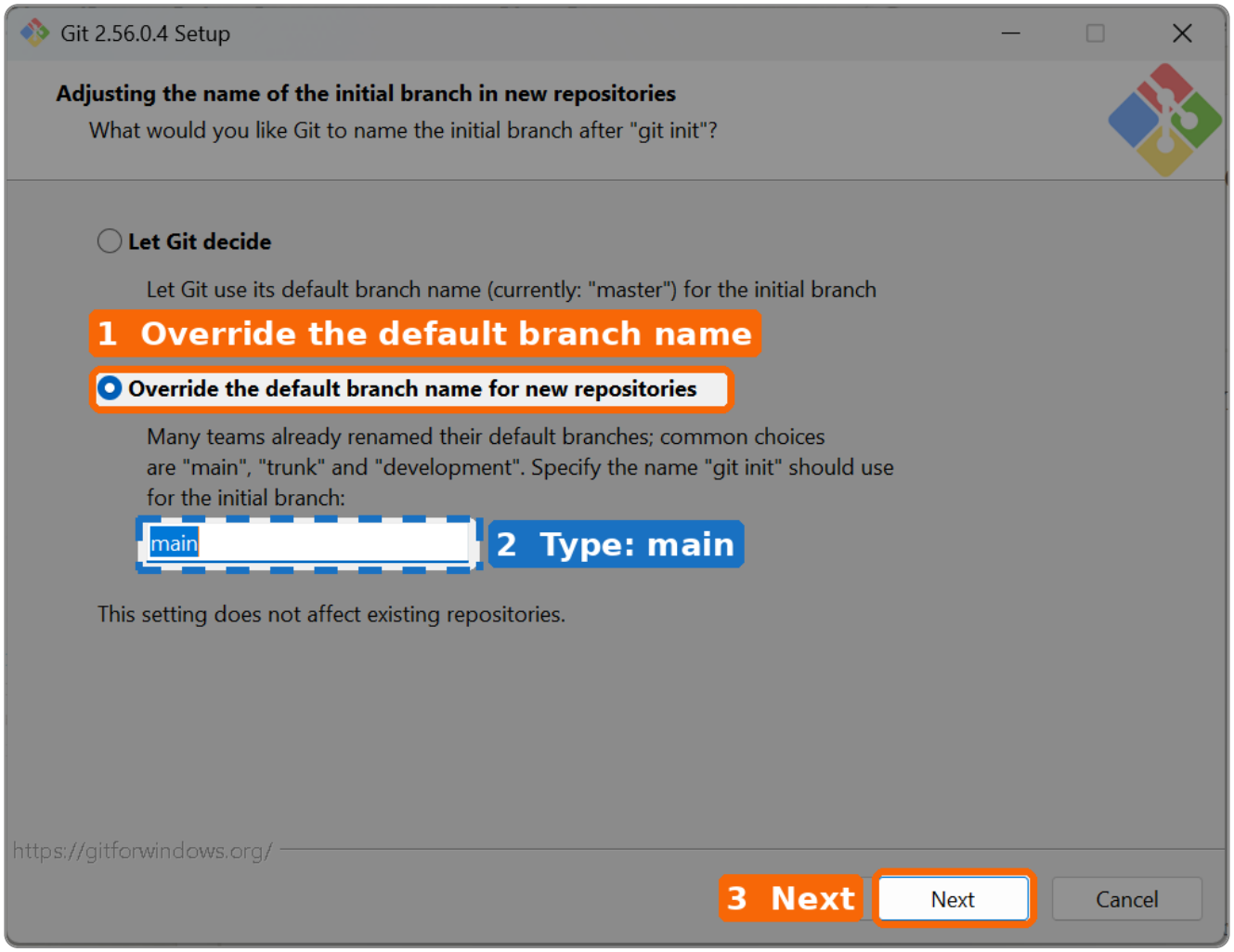
Git Setup › Adjusting the name of the initial branch

Click **Override the default branch name for new repositories**.

Check the box says `main`.

Click **Next**.

GitHub calls the first branch main, so Git will too.



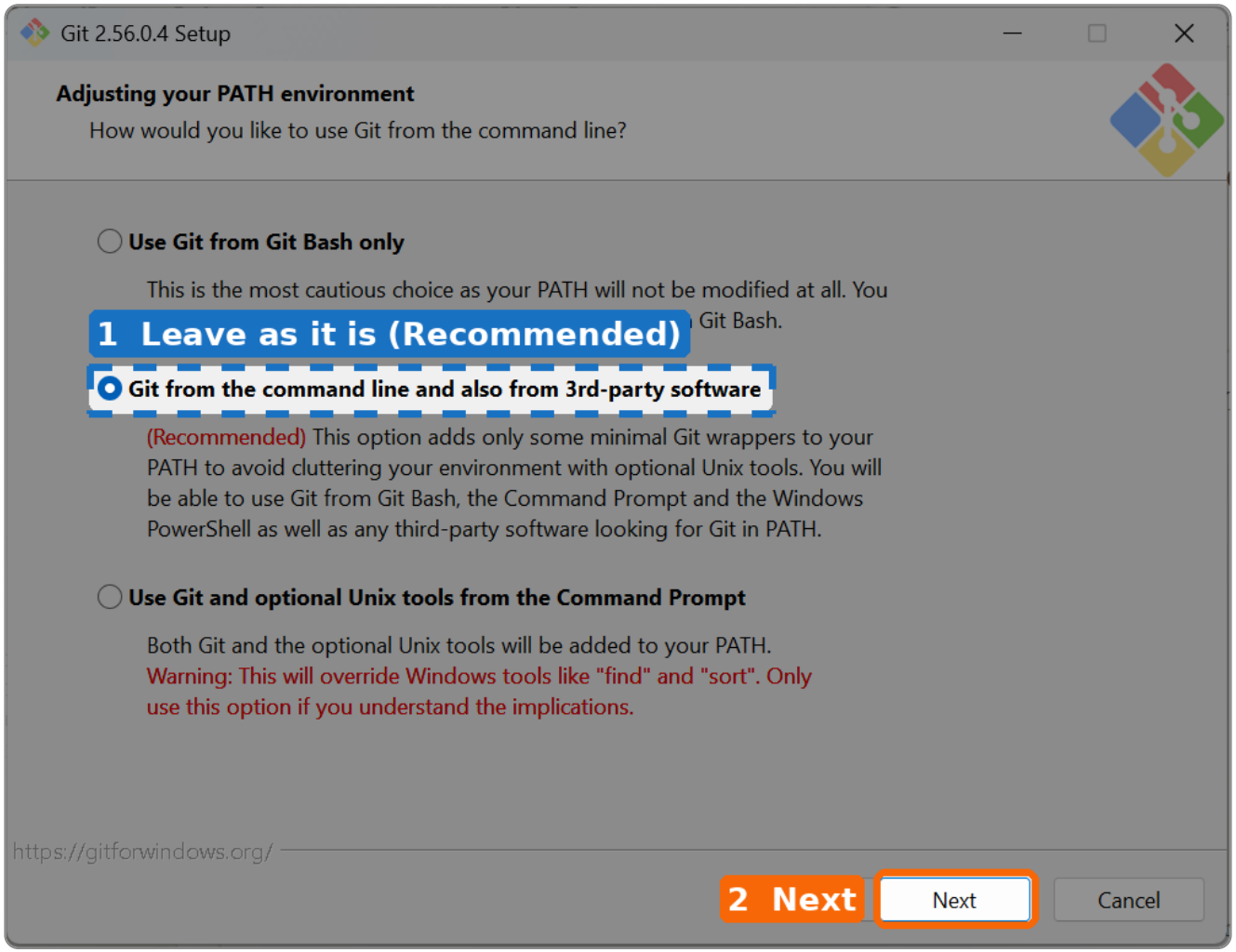
8

Git Setup › the rest of the screens

Leave everything as it is and click **Next** on each screen.

Stop when you reach **Configuring extra options**.

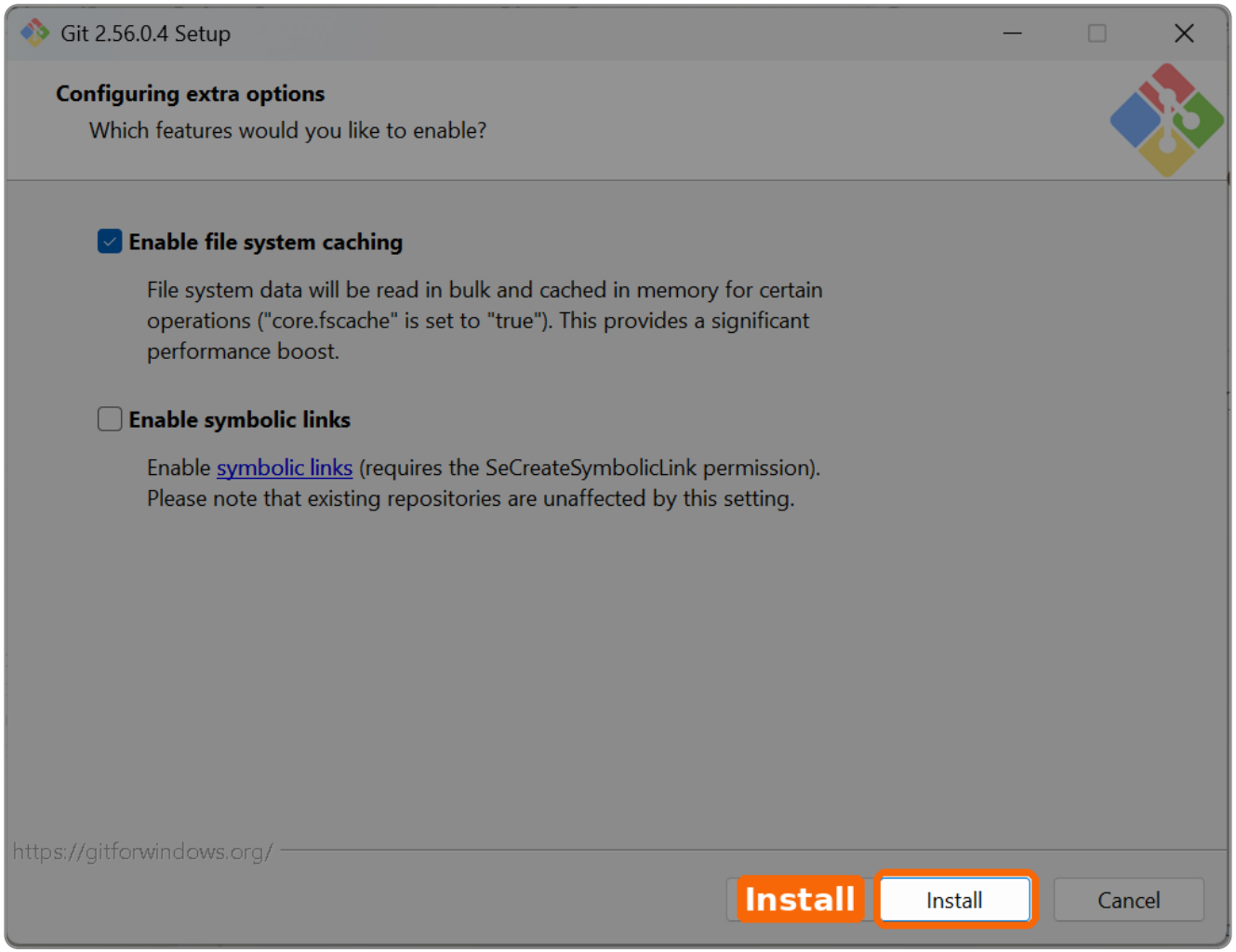
That's PATH, SSH, HTTPS, line endings, terminal, git pull and credential helper: seven screens.



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Git Setup › Configuring extra options

Click **Install**.

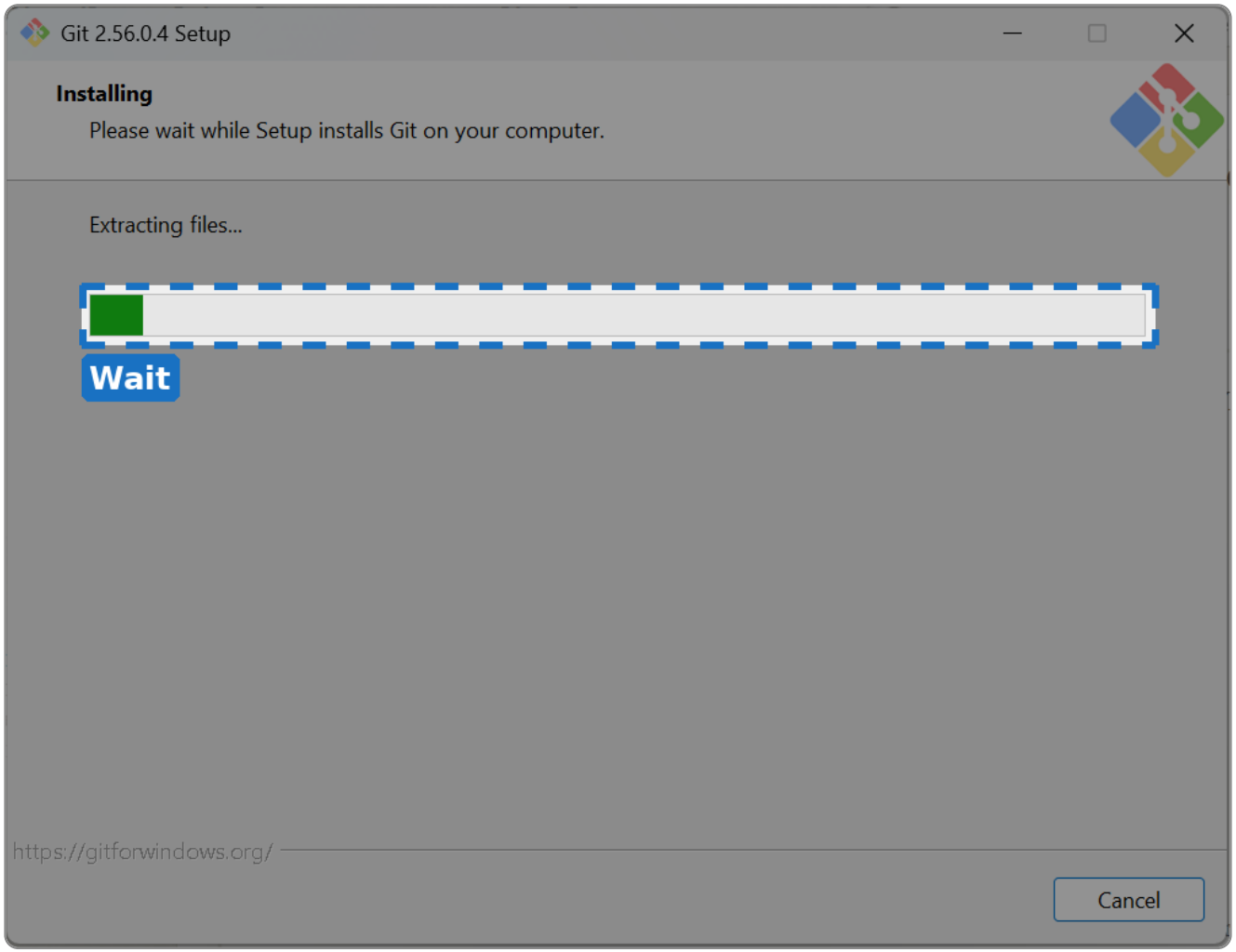


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Git Setup › Installing

Wait while it installs.

This takes a minute or two.

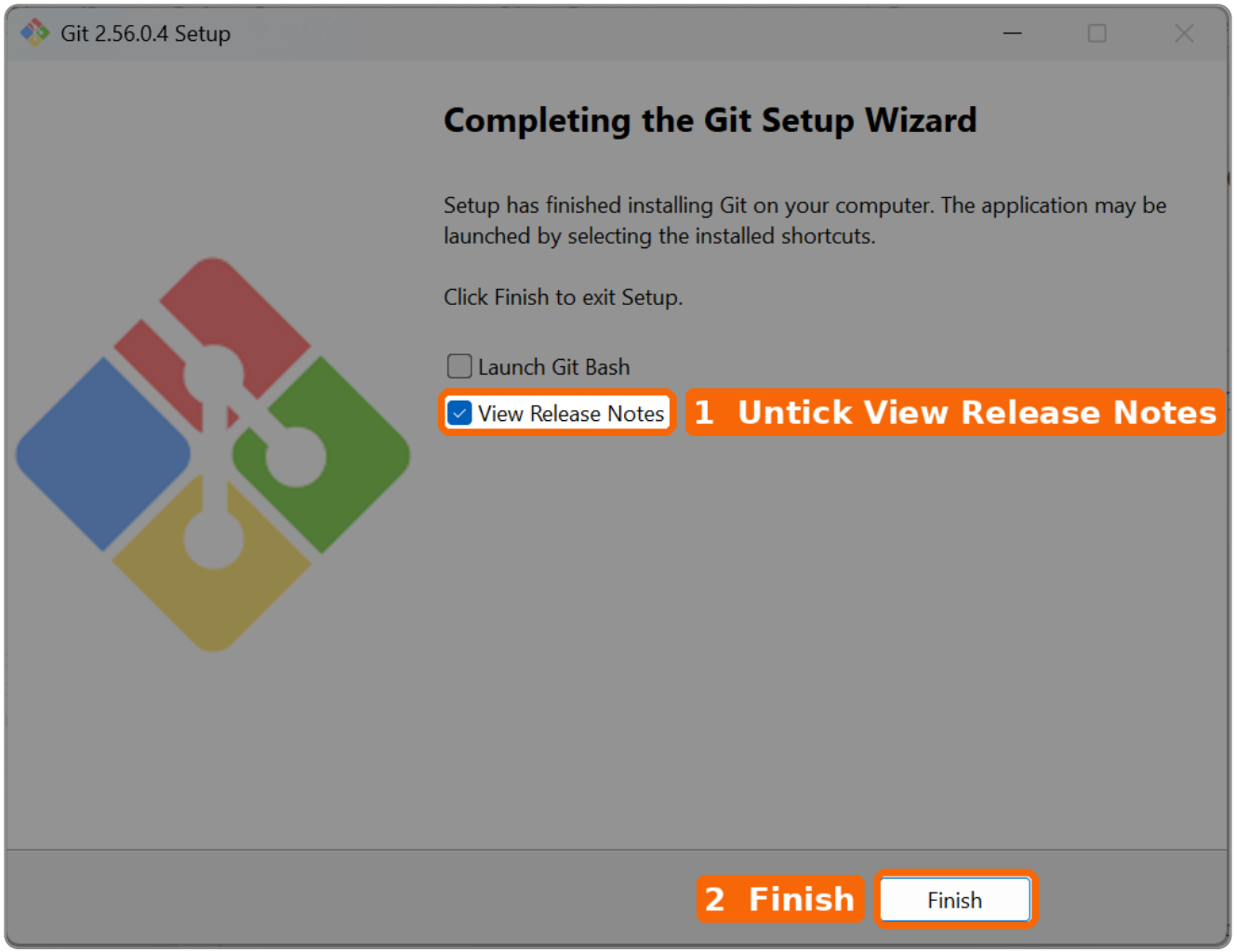


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Git Setup › Completing the Git Setup Wizard

Untick **View Release Notes**.

Click **Finish**.

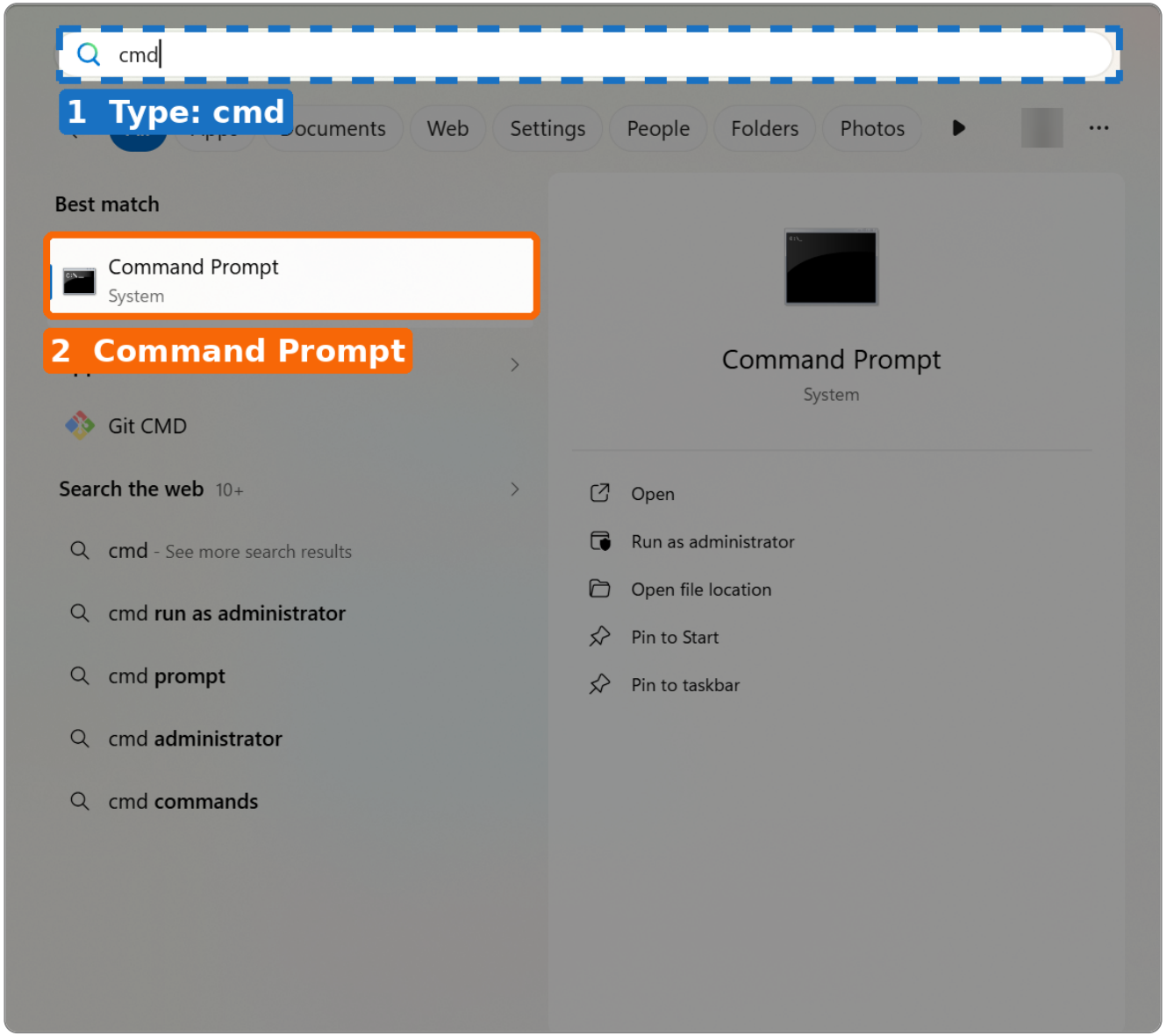


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Windows › Start

Click Start and type `cmd`.

Click **Command Prompt**.



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Command Prompt

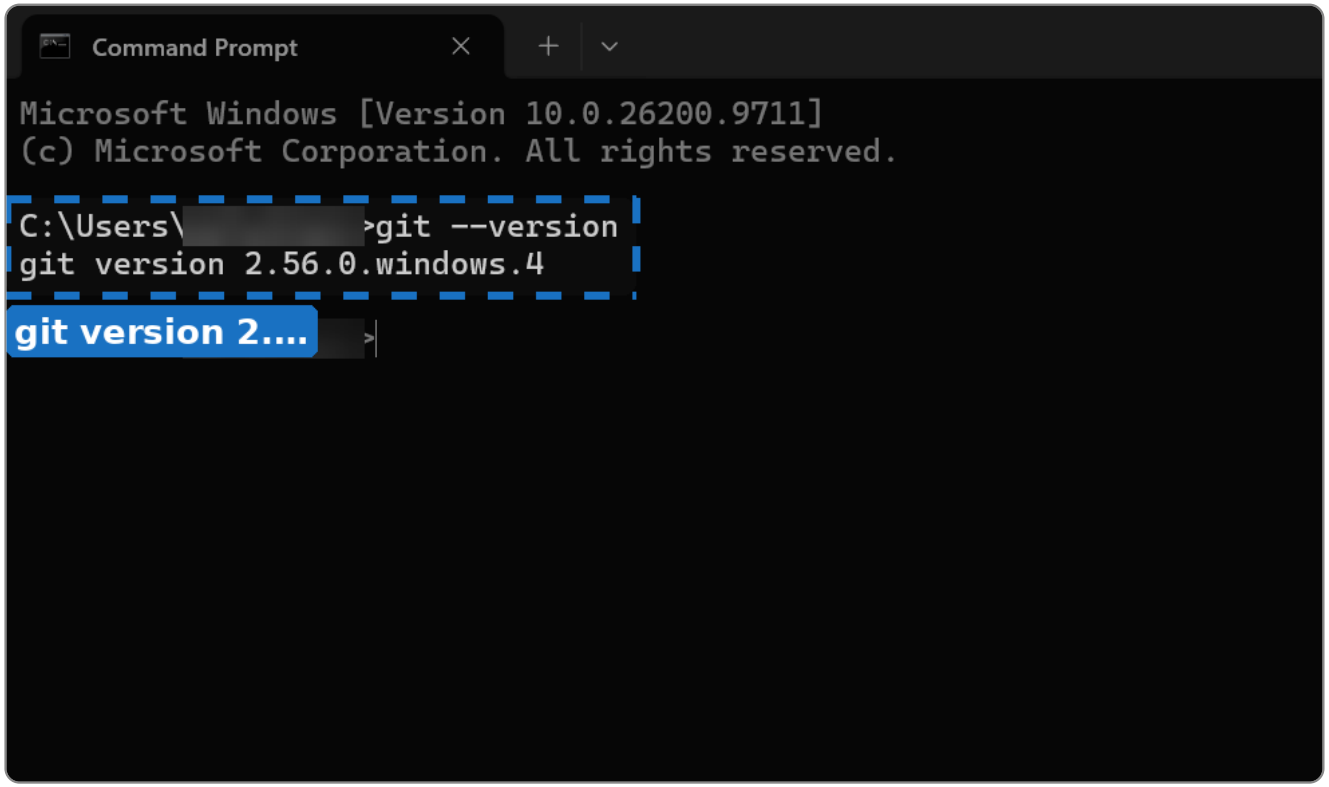
Type this, then press `Enter`:

```
git --version
```

> **Check:** a line starting `git version`, so Git is installed.

If something goes wrong

'git' is not recognized: close Command Prompt and open it again. Still there? Restart your computer.



Next

Tell Git your name and email (see the guide Set your Git name and email), then install GitHub Desktop (see the guide Install GitHub Desktop).

Checkpoint

- [ ] I can install Git.
- [ ] VS Code is Git's editor, and main is the first branch.
- [ ] `git --version` shows a version number.